

THEME 4 · B1+/B2

Advertising

4A Beating the Drum — expressing opinion personally/impersonally, showing annoyance/discomfort, reluctance

4B The Customer is Always Right — commercials, consumer–population relationship

Warm-up

Look at the title: Advertising. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

advertisement

n.



reklam

The advertisement appeared on television just before the evening news.

commercial

n.



reklam filmi

That commercial for the new phone has been on TV all week.

consumer

n.



tüketici

Companies study what consumers want before launching a product.

brand

n.



marka

Some people stay loyal to one brand of trainers for years.

slogan

n.



slogan

A good slogan can make a brand instantly recognisable.

jingle

n.



reklam müziği

I still remember the jingle from a cereal advert I watched as a child.

target audience

n. phrase



hedef kitle

The target audience for this commercial is teenagers who love sport.

persuade

v.



ikna etmek

Good adverts persuade us to try a new product.

exaggerate

v.



abartmak

Some commercials exaggerate how well a product actually works.

eye-catching

adj.



dikkat çekici

The poster used eye-catching colours to stop people scrolling past.

gullible

adj.



saf, kolay kanan

Advertisers sometimes assume viewers are more gullible than they really are.

misleading

adj.



yanıltıcı

The company was fined for a misleading advertisement.

sponsor

v.



sponsor olmak

A sportswear brand sponsors the school's football tournament every year.

invest

v.



yatırım yapmak

The company decided to invest in a bold new advertising strategy.

withdraw

v.



(parayı) çekmek

She withdrew some cash before the big sale started.

put aside

phr. v. (transitive)



bir kenara ayırmak

Wise shoppers put aside a little money each month.

blow money on

phr. v. (transitive)



parayı çarçur etmek

He blew his whole paycheck on a gadget he'd seen advertised.

save up

phr. v. (intransitive/transitive)



para biriktirmek

I'm saving up for the phone in that advert.

pay off

phr. v. (transitive)



borcu tamamen ödemek

It took them two years to pay off the loan for their shop.

in demand

prep. phrase



rağbette, talep gören

After the campaign, the trainers were suddenly in demand everywhere.

Quick game · What's the word?

“para biriktirmek”

a save up

b eye-catching

c commercial

Quick game · What's the word?

“rağbette, talep gören”

a in demand

b consumer

c eye-catching

Quick game · What's the word?

“saf, kolay kanan”

a brand

b target audience

c gullible

Quick game · What's the word?

“(parayı) çekmek”

a put aside

b slogan

c withdraw

Quick game · What's the word?

“reklam müziği”

a eye-catching

b jingle

c misleading

Quick game · What's the word?

“borcu tamamen ödemek”

a persuade

b pay off

c in demand

GRAMMAR

Phrasal Verbs About Money

Notice

Before the campaign even started, the company decided to **invest** in a bold new advertising strategy.

After seeing the irresistible advert, she rushed to the bank to **withdraw** some cash.

Wise shoppers usually **put aside** a little money each month instead of buying every new product they see advertised.

He couldn't resist the flashy commercial and ended up **blowing money on** a gadget he didn't really need.

Look at the phrasal verbs in bold. Which ones are followed directly by an amount of money, and which ones need 'in' or 'on' before what the money is used for?

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

money you are not using yet

on/in + what the money is used for

money from a bank account

Complete the rule

Verbs like save up and put aside describe keeping _____.

✓ money you are not using yet

Complete the rule

Verbs like invest and blow (money) need _____ after them.

✓ on/in + what the money is used for

Complete the rule

Withdraw usually describes taking _____.

✓ money from a bank account

The rule

'Save up' and 'put aside' describe keeping money instead of spending it. 'Invest' and 'blow' describe spending money into/on something and are usually followed by 'in/on'. 'Withdraw' means to take money out of a bank account, and 'pay off' means to finish paying a debt completely.

TR 'Save up' ve 'put aside' parayı harcamadan biriktirmeyi anlatır. 'Invest' ve 'blow' bir şeyin içine/üstüne para harcamayı anlatır ve genellikle 'in/on' ile kullanılır. 'Withdraw' bankadan para çekmeyi, 'pay off' ise bir borcu tamamen ödemeyi ifade eder.

When? We use these phrasal verbs to talk about how adverts influence people, spending habits, or saving plans.

TR Reklamların insanları nasıl etkilediğini, harcama alışkanlıklarını ya da tasarruf planlarını anlatırken bu phrasal verb'leri kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

the company

+

invest / a large budget

+

in this year's campaign

The company invested a large budget in this year's campaign.

Build sentences

I + save up / for months + to buy the phone in the advert

I saved up for months to buy the phone in the advert.

Build sentences

she

+

withdraw / fifty lira

+

after seeing the sale advertised

She withdrew fifty lira after seeing the sale advertised.

Build sentences

most families

+

put aside / a little money

+

every week

Most families put aside a little money every week.

Build sentences

he

+

blow / his allowance

+

on things he saw in commercials

He blew his allowance on things he saw in commercials.

Build sentences

? / you + ever / pay off / a purchase +

in instalments after an advert convinced you

Have you ever paid off a purchase in instalments after an advert convinced you?

Your turn

Write four sentences about money and advertising: something you saved up for, something you (or someone you know) blew money on, something you put aside, and a question about paying something off.

I once saved up for...

I would never blow money on...

My family always puts aside...

Have you ever paid off...?

Form

POSITIVE

She saves up every month for new gadgets.

He invested in an online advertising course.

NEGATIVE

They didn't put aside enough money for emergencies.

I don't blow money on things I see advertised.

QUESTION

Did you withdraw enough cash for the sale?

Does your family put aside money each month?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.

Yes, we do. / No, we don't.

Error detective

He invested his salary a new business.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He invested his salary in a new business.**

Error detective

She blew her money the sale.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She blew her money on the sale.**

Error detective

He payed off his debt last week.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ He paid off his debt last week.

A · Choose the correct option.

After months of watching adverts for it, Zeynep finally decided to _____ for the new laptop.

a save up

b withdraw

c pay off

A · Choose the correct option.

The company decided to _____ heavily in a new advertising campaign.

a invest

b withdraw

c save up

A · Choose the correct option.

He walked into the bank to _____ some cash before the big sale.

a withdraw

b blow

c put aside

B · Complete with the correct form.

After seeing the same advert ten times, she finally _____
(blow) her savings on the product.

✓ **blew**

B · Complete with the correct form.

It's smart to _____ (put aside) a small amount every month, even for small purchases.

✓ put aside

B · Complete with the correct form.

They worked hard for two years to _____ (pay off) the loan for their shop.

✓ **pay off**

C · Judge the sentence.

She invested her money a new online store.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She invested her money in a new online store.**

C · Judge the sentence.

He put ten lira aside every week.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

They blew their entire budget on a single television commercial.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with the correct phrasal verb.

A: Did you ever _____ (blow) money on something just because of an advert?

✓ **blow**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct phrasal verb.

B: Yes! I _____ (blow) my whole allowance on trainers last month, but now I'm trying to _____ (save up) again.

✓ **blew / save up**

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

aside / little / a / week / every / puts / she

puts

a

little

week

aside

she

every

•

✓ **She puts a little aside every week.**

GRAMMAR

Personal and Impersonal Passive: Reporting Opinions About Advertising

Notice

It **is widely believed** that catchy jingles make products easier to remember.

Catchy jingles **are widely believed to make** products easier to remember.

It **is said** that advertising influences even careful shoppers.

Advertising **is said to influence** even careful shoppers.

Compare sentences 1 & 2, and sentences 3 & 4. Which sentence in each pair begins with 'It', and which begins with the real subject of the opinion?

Complete the rule

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

It + is/are + past participle + that clause

subject + is/are + past participle + to + infinitive

the same opinion in two different structures

Complete the rule

The impersonal passive structure is: _____.

✓ It + is/are + past participle + that clause

Complete the rule

The personal passive structure is: _____.

✓ **subject + is/are + past participle + to + infinitive**

Complete the rule

Both structures express _____, and are more formal and common in reports or news.

✓ the same opinion in two different structures

The rule

To report an opinion impersonally, use 'It is/are + past participle + that...' (It is said that advertising works). To report the same opinion personally, use subject + is/are + past participle + to + infinitive (Advertising is said to work). Both carry the same meaning, but the personal passive is often considered more fluent.

TR Bir görüşü kişisiz olarak bildirmek için 'It is/are + past participle + that...' kullanılır (It is said that advertising works). Aynı görüşü kişisel olarak bildirmek için ise özne + is/are + past participle + to + infinitive kullanılır (Advertising is said to work). İkisi de aynı anlamı taşır, ancak personal passive genellikle daha akıcı kabul edilir.

When? We use these structures to report general opinions about advertising, consumers or society in a more objective, formal way, without naming a personal source.

TR Reklamlar, tüketiciler ya da toplum hakkındaki genel görüşleri kişisel bir kaynak belirtmeden, daha nesnel ve resmi bir şekilde aktarmak istediğimizde bu yapıları kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

people / think

+

advertising / shape

+

children's choices

**It is thought that advertising shapes children's choices. /
Advertising is thought to shape children's choices.**

Build sentences

people / say

+

commercials / influence

+

how much we spend

**It is said that commercials influence how much we spend. /
Commercials are said to influence how much we spend.**

Build sentences

many / believe

+

bright colours / attract

+

more customers

It is believed that bright colours attract more customers. / Bright colours are believed to attract more customers.

Build sentences

experts / claim

+

repeated adverts / increase

+

brand recognition

**It is claimed that repeated adverts increase brand recognition. /
Repeated adverts are claimed to increase brand recognition.**

Build sentences

some / argue

+

online ads / target

+

teenagers unfairly

It is argued that online ads target teenagers unfairly. / Online ads are argued to target teenagers unfairly.

Build sentences

? / people / think + celebrity endorsements / make +
products more trustworthy

Is it thought that celebrity endorsements make products more trustworthy? / Are celebrity endorsements thought to make products more trustworthy?

Your turn

Write four sentences giving opinions about advertising, using both the impersonal (It is said that...) and the personal (Something is said to...) passive.

It is believed that...

Advertising is believed to...

It is often argued that...

Commercials are often said to...

Form

POSITIVE

It is believed that adverts shape our choices.
Adverts are believed to shape our choices.

NEGATIVE

It isn't thought that this campaign will succeed.
This campaign isn't thought to succeed.

QUESTION

Is it claimed that the advert is misleading?
Is the advert claimed to be misleading?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.

Error detective

Advertising is said influence our choices.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ Advertising is said to influence our choices.

Error detective

It is said advertising that works.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **It is said that advertising works.**

Error detective

Commercials are said working well.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Commercials are said to work well.**

A • Choose the correct option.

_____ that advertising affects children's food choices.

a It is said

b It says

c Is said

A • Choose the correct option.

Bright packaging _____ to attract shoppers' attention.

a is believed

b believes

c is believing

A • Choose the correct option.

_____ argued that online ads collect too much personal data.

a It is

b It's is

c Is

B · Complete with the correct form.

It _____ (think) that repeated jingles help people remember brands.

✓ is thought

B · Complete with the correct form.

Repeated adverts _____ (claim) _____ (increase) brand recognition.

✓ are claimed / to increase

B · Complete with the correct form.

It _____ (not / believe) that all adverts are honest.

✓ is not believed

C · Judge the sentence.

It is said that advertising influence people's habits.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **It is said that advertising influences people's habits.**

C · Judge the sentence.

Advertising is said to influence people's habits.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

It is believed advertising that shapes public opinion.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **It is believed that advertising shapes public opinion.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct passive form.

A: What _____ (say) about this new campaign?

✓ is said

Dialogue · Complete with the correct passive form.

**B: It _____ (claim) that it will double sales, and the product
_____ (expect) to sell out by Friday.**

✓ is claimed / is expected

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

work / said / advertising / to / is / well

is

advertising

to

said

well

work

•

✓ **Advertising is said to work well.**

READING

The Anatomy of a Slogan

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'the anatomy of a slogan' means?
2. Can you remember any advertising slogan or jingle by heart? Why do you think it stuck in your memory?

THE ANATOMY OF A SLOGAN · 1 / 3

Open any magazine or scroll through any app, and within seconds an advertisement will try to catch your eye. Behind every slogan, though, lies a surprising amount of psychology. Copywriters choose each word with care, often building a campaign around adjectives that grow gradually stronger — good, then great, then unbeatable — so that a product always sounds just a little more exciting than its rivals. A soap might be described first as 'gentle', then, a line later, as 'incredibly gentle', while a competitor's soap is quietly dismissed as merely 'ordinary'.

THE ANATOMY OF A SLOGAN · 2 / 3

Words are only half the story. Many successful campaigns also rely on a jingle — a short, catchy tune that sticks in a listener's memory long after the advert has finished.

Researchers who study consumer behaviour say that a jingle heard often enough becomes almost impossible to forget, even years later. This is no accident: advertisers deliberately repeat both the tune and the slogan across television, radio and social media, hoping that familiarity will eventually turn into trust.

THE ANATOMY OF A SLOGAN · 3 / 3

Not everyone is convinced that this approach is entirely honest. Critics argue that stacking one impressive adjective on top of another can mislead shoppers into expecting more than a product can actually deliver. For this reason, many schools now teach media literacy, encouraging young consumers to ask a simple question before they buy: is this slogan describing the product, or just describing a feeling the advertiser wants me to have?

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a Slogans are chosen randomly by advertisers.

b Advertisers carefully choose increasingly strong words and repeat jingles to influence consumers.

c Jingles are no longer used in modern advertising.

While you read

Copywriters often build a campaign around adjectives that grow _____ across the text.

✓ **gradually stronger**

While you read

According to the text, why do advertisers repeat a jingle across many platforms?

a

To make it illegal for rivals to copy

b

To make it hard for actors to remember their lines

c

To build familiarity that can turn into trust

While you read

According to the text, all critics believe slogans are completely honest.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **According to the text, critics argue that stacking exaggerated adjectives can mislead shoppers.**

While you read

Many schools now teach _____ to help young consumers question adverts.

✓ media literacy

After you read

1. Do you think exaggerated slogans are a harmless part of advertising, or a kind of dishonesty? Why?
2. Think of a product. Write one 'plain' and one 'exaggerated' slogan for it.

READING

Buy Now, Think Later?

Before you read

1. What do you think the title 'Buy Now, Think Later?' suggests about advertising?
2. Do you think adverts affect your own spending decisions? Give an example.

BUY NOW, THINK LATER? · 1 / 3

It is widely believed that advertising simply informs consumers about new products, but psychologists argue that its real power lies elsewhere. Adverts are said to work by creating an emotional connection — with happiness, status or the fear of missing out — long before the shopper consciously considers whether they actually need the item. By the time reasoning takes over, an emotional decision may already have been made.

BUY NOW, THINK LATER? · 2 / 3

This idea troubles many economists, who point out that entire populations can be nudged toward spending patterns that don't always serve their own interests. Families are sometimes encouraged, through relentless advertising, to blow money on the latest gadget rather than put aside savings for less exciting but more important goals. It is claimed that low-income households are particularly vulnerable, since a single well-timed advertisement can outweigh weeks of careful budgeting.

BUY NOW, THINK LATER? · 3 / 3

Not all commentators are so pessimistic, however. Some argue that advertising, used responsibly, helps a population make informed comparisons between products, and that today's consumers are far less gullible than earlier generations assumed. Whichever view is correct, most agree on one thing: understanding how an advert is trying to persuade you is the first step toward deciding, calmly, whether to reach for your wallet.

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a Advertising only gives factual information about products.

b Advertising can influence emotions and spending before reasoning takes over, which raises concerns for some commentators but not all.

c All economists agree that advertising should be banned.

While you read

Adverts are said to work by creating an _____ connection before reasoning takes over.

✓ **emotional**

While you read

According to the text, all commentators believe advertising is harmful.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, some commentators believe advertising can help consumers make informed comparisons.

While you read

According to the text, who is claimed to be particularly vulnerable to well-timed advertisements?

a Retired shoppers

b Low-income households

c Company shareholders

While you read

The text suggests that families are sometimes encouraged to _____ money on gadgets rather than save it.

✓ **blow**

After you read

1. Do you agree that some groups of people are more vulnerable to advertising than others? Why or why not?
2. What is one thing you could do before buying something you saw advertised?

LISTENING

That Advert Again?!

Before you listen

1. Predict: what kind of advert do you think annoys people the most, and why?

That Advert Again?!

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

Why is Mert irritated?

a He lost his phone.

b The same advert keeps interrupting his show.

c Aslı changed the channel.

While you listen

Mert says he would rather not buy the phone because he is
_____ for something else.

✓ saving up

While you listen

Aslı is saving money to buy the advertised phone.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Aslı is putting money aside for a trip this summer.**

While you listen

What does Mert mean by 'I just wish adverts would let us watch one episode in peace'?

a

He wants fewer advert interruptions.

b

He wants more adverts.

c

He wants to watch a different show.

LISTENING

Our Favourite (and Least Favourite) Commercials

Before you listen

1. What makes a TV commercial memorable — being funny, aggressive, confident, or something else?

Our Favourite (and Least Favourite) Commercials

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What kind of commercial does Kerem describe as his favourite?

a A funny snack advert

b A confident sports-brand advert

c An aggressive insurance advert

While you listen

Defne describes the snack advert as loud and _____.

✓ aggressive

While you listen

Both students agree the insurance advert is their favourite.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Both students agree the insurance advert is the most annoying one.**

While you listen

Why does Defne like the snack advert, according to the dialogue?

a Because it's calm and quiet

b Because it's memorable for being over the top

c Because it never repeats

SPEAKING

Reluctantly Persuaded?

In pairs, discuss how advertising affects people's spending habits. Talk about at least two examples, using money phrasal verbs (save up, put aside, blow money on, pay off) and expressions of reluctance (I'd rather not..., I'm not really keen on...).

SPEAKING

Presenting a Commercial

Prepare a two-minute talk about a TV or online commercial you find especially memorable, in a good or bad way. Describe what happens in it, how the speaker or actors sound (confident, aggressive, funny, calming...), and why it sticks in your mind.

WRITING

Letter of Application: Student Exchange Programme

Write a formal letter applying for a student exchange programme you saw advertised at your school. Explain who you are, why you are applying, and what you hope to gain from the experience.

WRITING

Design an Advertisement

Write the text for an advertisement poster for a product or service of your choice. Include an eye-catching slogan, a short description of the product, and at least one persuasive technique from this theme (exaggeration, a target-audience appeal, a catchy phrase).

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

After weeks of seeing the trainers advertised, Elif finally decided to _____ for them.

a save up

b withdraw

c pay off

Exit ticket

The company chose to _____ heavily in a new online campaign.

a invest

b blow

c withdraw

Exit ticket

It _____ (believe) that catchy jingles help people remember a brand.

✓ is believed

Exit ticket

Repeated adverts _____ (claim) _____ (increase) brand recognition.

✓ are claimed / to increase

Exit ticket

Which word describes something that attracts attention immediately?

a eye-catching

b gullible

c misleading

Exit ticket

Advertising is said influence people's choices.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Advertising is said to influence people's choices.**

Exit ticket

A person who buys and uses goods or services is called a

_____ .

✓ consumer

Exit ticket

Which sentence correctly uses the impersonal passive?

a

It is said that the campaign was a success.

b

It is said the campaign was a success that.

c

Is said that the campaign was a success.

Exit ticket

He _____ (blow) his whole allowance on a gadget from an advert.

✓ blew

Exit ticket

A short, catchy tune used in advertising is called a _____.

a jingle

b slogan

c brand

Exit ticket

**Making something seem better than it really is means to
_____ it.**

✓ exaggerate

Exit ticket

Put the words in order.

is

work

advertising

said

to

well

•

✓ **Advertising is said to work well.**

Exit ticket

Rewrite using the correct money phrasal verb.

(He finished paying all his debt for the shop equipment. (pay off))

✓ **He paid off his debt for the shop equipment.**

Exit ticket

They put aside a little money aside every week.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **They put a little money aside every week.**